

RANRAN LI

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ACADEMIC POSITION

2025 – Postdoc researcher (Humboldt Postdoc Fellow from 2026)
Dept. Criminology
Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law, Germany

EDUCATION

2020 – 2025 PhD in Personality Psychology
Dissertation: Unlocking Personality: How situational strength and situational affordances shape behavioral expression. <https://doi.org/10.5463/thesis.1256>
Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Netherlands

2024–25 PhD research visit, *Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law*

2018 – 2020 Research Master's in Psychology (with merit)
University of Amsterdam, Netherlands

2016–17 Global Exchange, *University of Münster, Germany*

2014 – 2018 BSc in Psychology (distinction)
Soochow University, Taiwan

RESEARCH STATEMENT

With the belief that ‘*Serious inquiry into human nature is not a luxury*,’ I study how personality traits and situational factors jointly shape human behavior. My research spans both socially constructive behaviors (e.g., prosociality) and behaviors that are harmful to oneself or others (e.g., dishonesty, delinquency). I am currently applying this *person–situation interaction perspective* to the study of bystander intervention.

Grounded in rigorous empirical methods, I am equally drawn to theoretical integration—delineating micro-level psychological processes and linking them to broader macro-structures.

While psychology remains my ‘*Forever Moonlight*,’ I have interdisciplinary interests and pursuits. At present, I am actively bridging psychology with criminology, behavioral economics, and sociocultural perspectives. I am additionally interested in philosophy of science (meta-science)

and computational social science.

Support good science – open, rigorous, and trustworthy science – always on the way.

PUBLICATIONS

Publications from PhD

Li, R., Thielmann, I., Balliet, D., & De Vries, R. E. (2025). Trait activation in daily life: Comparing two perspectives on person-situation interactions. *Journal of Research in Personality*, 104689. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrp.2025.104689>

◇ Received SeedCorn Research Grant €3,000 for the project, Kurt Lewin Institute

◇ Organized a symposium at the International Convention of Psychological Science (ICPS), Brussels, Mar 2023, “Trait and situation activation in daily life and organizational settings”

{HEXACO-behavior}
{empirical: diary study}

Li, R., Balliet, D., Thielmann, I., & De Vries, R. E. (2024). Revisiting situational strength: Do strong situations restrict variance in behaviors? *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1037/pspi0000475>

◇ Received multiple awards for the paper, including Best Paper Award @ Dutch Work & Organizational Psychology conference, Tilburg, Netherlands (2022), Runner-up for the Best Paper Award, Kurt Lewin Institute, Netherlands (2024), and Best Student Presentation Award at the International Conference on Social Dilemmas, Leiden, Netherlands (2024).

◇ Chaired a methodological session “Methodological Advances in OB research” at the Academy of Management (AOM), Boston, Aug 2023:

{prosocial behavior}
{empirical: social dilemma games; meta-analysis}

Li, R., Thielmann, I., Balliet, D., & De Vries, R. E. (2023). Development of the Generic Situational Strength (GSS) scale: Measuring situational strength across contexts. In L. R. Ford & T. A. Scandura (Eds.), *The SAGE Handbook of Survey Development and Application*. <https://doi.org/10.4135/9781529617757.n35>

{empirical: scale development}

Li, R. Revisiting person-situation interactionism. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 2, 6 (2023). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s44159-022-00139-8>

{person-situation processes}
{conceptual}

> *in the pipeline...*

Li, R., Thielmann, I., Balliet, D., & De Vries, R. (R&R 2nd round). When dishonesty pays off: Incentives foster trait activation of Honesty-Humility.

◇ Received iBBA Online Experiment Grant €2,500, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam

{dishonesty}
{empirical: experimental cheating games}

Publications beyond and after PhD

Li, R., De Vries, R. E., Van Gelder, J.-L. (2026). Entangled pathways to delinquency: An integrative process model of personality, situations, and macro-structures. *Zeitschrift für Psychologie*.

◇ Co-organizing a panel at the European Society of Criminology (ESC), Warsaw, Sept 2026, “Virtual Reality as a window into crime: Personality, situations, and psychological processes”

{person-situation processes}

{theoretical integration}

Ye, Z., Long, F., Feng, R., van Dijk, W., & **Li, R.** (2026). People feel but don't tell: Dispositional honesty and emotional responses to others' (mis)fortunes. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 126, 104966. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2026.104966>

{empathy}

{empirical: vignette; retro diary; real-time interaction}

Li, R., & Wilt, J. A. (2025). Situated selves: A cyclical model of personality expression in context. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, 102104. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102104>

{person-situation processes}

{conceptual}

Van Gelder, J.-L., **Li, R.**, Wiechert, S., & Frankenhuys, W. E. (2025). Short-term mindsets: Beyond traits and self-regulation. *Current Opinion in Psychology*, 102112. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsyc.2025.102112>

{conceptual}

Li, R., & Zettler, I. (2025). Entangled Minds: A roadmap for bridging cultural and personality psychology research. *Personality Science*, 6. <https://doi.org/10.1177/27000710251388772>

{conceptual}

> *in the pipeline...*

Li, R., Knabe, M., Derakhshan, S., Arui, A.-K., & Van Gelder, J.-L. (submitted). Beyond immersion and presence: Rethinking validity in Virtual Reality criminology.

{VR method-conceptual}

He, Y., & **Li, R.** (submitted). Helping in the dark: Toward a science of prosociality under risk.

He, Y., & **Li, R.** (submitted). Prosociality under risk: A conceptual synthesis and roadmap for future research.

{prosocial behavior}

{conceptual}

Li, R. (submitted). The Soul of Science: On integrity in an age of pragmatic academia.

> *other ongoing projects...*

Li, R., De Vries, R. E., Barnum, T., Herman, S., Tisdall, L., Van Gelder, J.-L. A trait–state model of reactive guardianship: Psychological pathways to bystander intervention. *Manuscript in prep.*

{bystander intervention}
{empirical: Virtual Reality experiment}

Li, R., Van Gelder, J.-L., & De Vries, R. E. Who goes where and why? A meta-analytic review of personality and situation selection. *Manuscript in prep.*

{person-situation processes}
{meta-analysis, theoretical}

Umashev, N., **Li, R.,** Rusch, H. Agent incentives: How agents trade off incentives and exploitation risk in principal selection. *Manuscript in prep.*

{personality & exploitation}
{empirical: sequential experimental games}

van Lissa, C., Ballou, N., **Li, R.,** et al. Self-determination theory: Theory specification. *Manuscript in prep.*

{method: formal theory}

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Slides/posters available at osf.io/a83tv

Panel Co-organizer: European Society of Criminology (ESC), Warsaw, Sept 2026: “Virtual Reality as a window into crime: Personality, situations, and psychological processes”

Symposium Organizer: International Convention of Psychological Science (ICPS), Brussels, Mar 2023: “Trait and situation activation in daily life and organizational settings”

Session Moderator: Academy of Management (AOM), Boston, Aug 2023: “Methodological Advances in OB Research”

Other presentations (selected):

Personality Psychology (& Psychology General)	European Conference of Personality (ECP); Summer School of Personality Science (SSPS); Association for Research in Personality (ARP) conference; Differentielle Psychologie (DPPD) conference; Kurt Lewin Institute (KLI) Conference; German Psychological Science Congress (DGPs)	Edinburgh, July 2026; Berlin, Aug 2024; Madrid, Aug 2022; Evanston, July 2023; Kassel, Sept 2025; Utrecht, April 2024; Luxembourg, Sept 2026;
Criminology	European Society of Criminology (ESC) conference; American Society of Criminology (ASC) conference;	Warsaw, Sept 2026 Washington DC, Nov 2025
Behavioral Economics/ Interdisciplinary	International Conference on Social Dilemmas (ICSD); Cognition, Behavior, & Evolution Network (CBEN) conference; Matterhorn Symposium;	Leiden, July 2024; Maastricht, Oct 2024; Leiden, April 2026; Brig, Switzerland, Sept 2025;

Management	Academy of Management (AOM) conference; Working community of Dutch Work & Organizational Psychology (WAOP),	Boston 2023; Tilburg, Nov 2022; Groningen, Nov 2023
Others: VR, Tech	Machine+Behavior conference; XR meeting; VIRTUES VR meeting; Summer Institute Computational Social Science	Berlin, April 2026; Würzburg, Oct 2025; Hagen, Sept 2025; Rotterdam, June 2022;

GRANTS, AWARDS

Grants/Fellowship

2026	Humboldt Postdoc Fellowship: two-year
2025	Chinese Government Award for Outstanding PhDs: \$6,000
2024	DAAD (German Academic Exchange Service) Research Grant: Bi-nationally Supervised Doctoral Degrees, €1,300*7 months
2024	iBBA Online Experiment Grant €2,500, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
2021	Kurt Lewin Institute (KLI) SeedCorn Research Grant €3,000

Awards

2024	Best Student Presentation Award , International Conference on Social Dilemmas (ICSD), Leiden, Netherlands
2024	Runner-up for the Best Paper Award , Kurt Lewin Institute, Netherlands
2022	Best Paper Award , Working community of Dutch Work & Organizational Psychology (WAOP) conference, Tilburg, Netherlands

Scholarship

2024	Travel Grant European Conference of Personality (ECP)
2023	Academy of Management (AOM) conference registration scholarship
2017	DAAD (German Grant Institute) - STIBET fellowship
2014 - 2018	Soochow University Scholarship for students with outstanding academic performance (*7 times); Franklin Scholarships for Dual Degree of Soochow University (*3 times). Sum up to NT\$ 400,000 ($\approx 12,680\text{€}$)

REVIEWING

Personality and Social Psychology Review: *Emerging Editorial Board* (2023–2025; 4);
European Journal of Personality (4);
Collabra: Psychology (1);
Health Psychology (1);

Zeitschrift für Psychologie (1);
 Current Research in Ecological and Social Psychology (1);
 Social Psychology (1);
 European Journal on Criminal Policy and Research (1);
 SAGE Handbook of Survey Development and Application (1).

TEACHING

Thesis supervision Master thesis supervision and assessment, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam*
 Sebastiaan Schulters (2023-2024),
 Savannah Huxtable (2023-2024),
 Daria Hovorukha (student from Ukraine, 2022-2023),
 Lara Vogel (2022-2023),
 Zihan Wang (2022-2023),
 Chenyu Tang (2021-2022),
 Sofia Canelos (2021-2022),
 Nora Choa (2020-2022).
 Bachelor thesis supervision, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam*
 Roe Bakker (2021-2022).

Guest Lecture Invited Guest Lecture “Personality, Situations, Behavior in Organizational Settings”, Feb 2024, *Amsterdam Business School, University of Amsterdam*

Grading Grading master’s course ‘Personality at Work’, *Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam*
 Grading bachelor’s course ‘Methodological Research Projects’, *University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam Business School*

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Translations for cross-cultural projects @*Psychological Science Accelerator* (and colleagues’) to enhance the generalizability of psychological science.

Columnist: Promote science communication in personality-social psychology, promote methodological rigor in scientific practices. Selected blogs include:

- ❖ How situational settings influence behavior: New insights from behavioral research. (2024). Kudos: American Psychological Association (APA) showcases.
<https://www.growkudos.com/publications/10.1037%252Fpspi0000475/>
- ❖ Recent Development in Personality Assessment. (2022). Amsterdam Leadership Lab.
<https://www.amsterdamleadershiplab.nl/recent-development-in-personality-assessment>

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